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HOW (NOT) TO READ THE BIBLE · SESSION 2

Stranger Things

Reading the Old Testament law through Jesus

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LAST WEEK

What’s the context?

Literary · Historical · The Bible’s big story

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ICEBREAKER

Real or fake?

1. “You shall not wear cloth of wool and linen mixed together.”
2. “You shall not boil a young goat in its mother’s milk.”
3. “God helps those who help themselves.”
4. “You shall not round off the hair on your temples.”
5. “Cleanliness is next to godliness.”
6. “You shall love your neighbor as yourself.”

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Video: Session 2

Jot notes on the front of your handout as you watch

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VIDEO DEBRIEF

Talk it over

1. Which “strange” law surprised you most? Why does it sound so odd?
2. Where does Leviticus fall on the Bible’s timeline? Why does that matter?
3. What was the law **for**? Why rules about food, clothing, and haircuts?
4. How would you answer, “Christians just pick and choose”?

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THE BIG IDEA

The law was God’s good gift to Israel, and we read it through Jesus, who fulfilled it.

Matthew 5:17

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THE BIG STORY

Where is Leviticus on the timeline?

1

Creation

Genesis 1–2

God makes a good world

2

Fall

Genesis 3

Sin breaks everything

3

Promise

Genesis 12

God calls Abraham

4 · Leviticus is here

Sinai

Exodus–Deuteronomy

The law of Moses, given to Israel

5 · We live here

Jesus

Gospels–Acts

The new covenant in his blood

6

Restoration

Revelation 21–22

All things made new

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THE METHOD

Four questions for any Old Testament law

1. Who received it?

Usually Israel, under the covenant at Sinai

2. What was it for, then?

Holiness, worship, justice, or care for the vulnerable

3. What does the New Testament do with it?

Repeated, fulfilled in Christ, or set aside

4. What does it show about God?

His unchanging character, and how that shapes life in Christ

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HOW CHRISTIANS HAVE READ IT

Two faithful approaches

Threefold division

Moral law still binds. Ceremonial law is fulfilled in Christ. Civil law ended with Israel as a nation.

Calvin · Westminster · 1689 London Baptist Confession

Fulfilled as a whole

The Mosaic law is one covenant, fulfilled in Christ. We live under “the law of Christ,” and commands carry forward as the New Testament takes them up.

Many Baptist and evangelical scholars today

Both hold that all Scripture is God’s Word and that Christ fulfilled the law. They usually reach the same conclusions.

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WORKSHOP · PASSAGE 1

Sort Leviticus 19

"You shall be holy, for I the Lord your God am holy." (v. 2)

R · Repeated

The New Testament restates it directly

F · Fulfilled

Christ fulfilled it, or the New Testament sets it aside

C · Carried forward

The principle carries forward in a new form

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WORKSHOP · PASSAGE 2

Mark 7:14–23

Observe

- What argument started this? (vv. 1–5)
- What can’t defile a person? (v. 15)
- What does Mark add in verse 19?
- Where does defilement come from? (vv. 21–23)

Interpret

- What were the food laws pointing to?
- Read Acts 10:9–16, 28. What was Peter’s vision really about?
- What’s the timeless truth?

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PRACTICE THE ANSWER

“You’re just picking and choosing.”

A GOOD ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

“Those laws were given to Israel under a specific covenant. Jesus fulfilled it, and the New Testament itself tells us which commands carry forward. Loving my neighbor is repeated. The fabric law was a picture of holiness that pointed to Christ.”

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THIS WEEK

Read the law through Jesus

- Run one take-home law through the four questions
- Next week, *Boys' Club Christianity*: what does the Bible say about women?
- Read 1 Timothy 2 and 1 Corinthians 14:26–40, and bring your honest questions

"As he who called you is holy, you also be holy in all your conduct." 1 Peter 1:15